



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: Nov 13, 2024	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident involving unauthorized access and suspicious account activity on a company workstation.
Tool(s) used	Linux command line SIEM alert dashboard Log analysis tools (syslog viewer)
The 5 W's	• Who: A malicious external actor who gained unauthorized access using stolen employee credentials. • What: A credential-based intrusion resulting in unauthorized logins, installation of unknown software, and attempted privilege escalation on the compromised workstation. • Where: The incident occurred on an employee workstation located in the Finance department of the organization. • When: The suspicious activity occurred on Monday between 1:35 a.m. and 2:10 a.m., outside normal business hours. • Why: The attacker likely obtained the employee's username and password through a phishing email sent earlier that week. Once logged in, the intruder attempted to elevate system privileges and download sensitive financial data. The motive appears to be financial gain and data theft.

Additional notes	1. What steps should be taken to re-secure the employee's account and workstation? 2. Does evidence suggest lateral movement attempts into other machines or departments? 3. Should multi-factor authentication (MFA) be enforced for all employees moving forward? 4. Are additional log sources needed to fully investigate the attacker's actions?
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